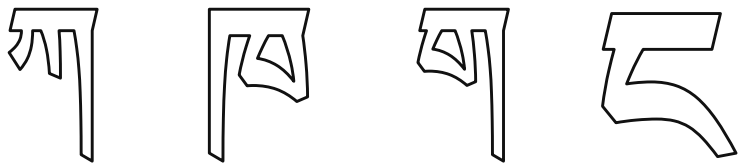
ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 26

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Dzongkha Alphabet

རྫོང་ཁའི་ཀ་ཁ།

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 34 Dzongkha Letters with English Phonetics



Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Dzongkha Alphabet — རྫོང་ཁའི་ཀ་ཁ།
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 26

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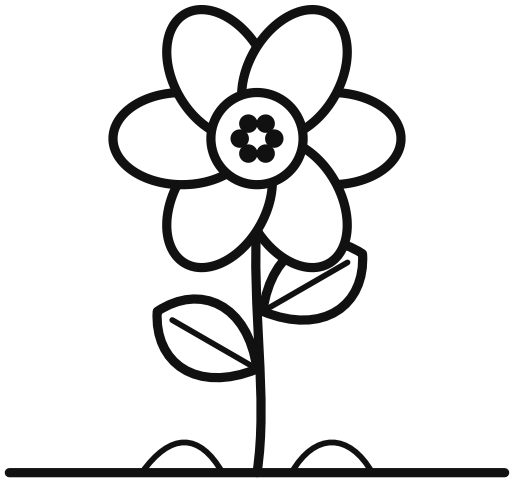
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Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

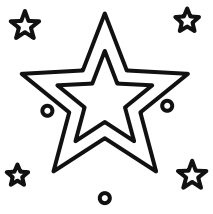
Fonts: Noto Serif Tibetan, Jomolhari (by Christopher Fynn) and Baloo 2, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License. **Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

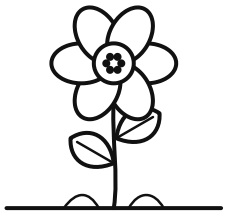


This book belongs to
དེབ་འདི་ ... གི་ཨིན།

I started learning Dzongkha on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 26 is Dzongkha. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- An **h** after a consonant (**kh, chh, th, ph, tsh**) means a little puff of air. Without the h, say it with no puff: **k** as in "skip", not "kite".
- **c** is 'ch' with no puff of air; **chh** is 'ch' with a puff.
- **ä** and **ö** are like the vowels in German: *rä* rhymes with "bed" said long; *ö* is 'e' said with round lips.
- Dzongkha has **high** and **low** tones. Each letter page says which one the letter has.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Dzongkha name** written in Dzongkha (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *With the 4 vowels · tone* shows the letter with each vowel sign (ཀ ཀི ཀུ ཀེ ཀོ = ka ki ku ke ko), the way children in Bhutan practise it, and says whether the letter has a high or a low tone.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow the Dzongkha spoken in western Bhutan (Thimphu and Punakha).

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Dzongkha! རྫོང་ཁ

dzong-kha — the Dzongkha word for the language

Who speaks it?
Dzongkha is the **national language of Bhutan**. About **170,000 people** speak it as their first language, and many more Bhutanese learn it at school.[3]

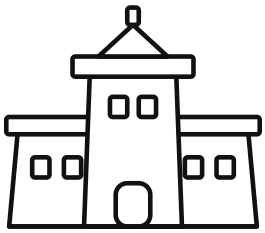
Where?
In the **Kingdom of Bhutan**, high in the **eastern Himalaya mountains**, with snowy peaks, forests and deep green valleys.

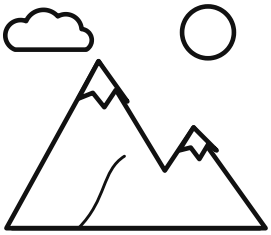
How is it written?
In the **Tibetan script**, written the Bhutanese way, from **left to right**, with a small dot ་ after every syllable.

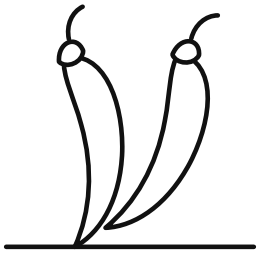
How many letters?
30 consonants and **4 vowel signs** — **34** in this book.

What does the name mean?
Dzongkha means "the language of the **dzong**" — the big white fortress buildings found in Bhutan's valleys.

Did you know?
Bhutan's favourite food is *ema datshi*: chillies with cheese. *Ema* ཨེ་མ means chilli — you will find it on the page for ཨ!







The Dzongkha Alphabet ཀ་ད

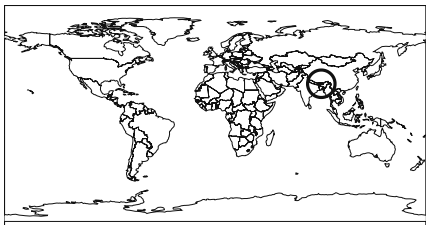
30 consonants – གསལ་བྱེད

ཀ *ka*	ཁ *kha*	ག *ga*	ང *nga*
ཅ *ca*	ཆ *cha*	ཇ *ja*	ཉ *nya*
ཏ *ta*	ཐ *tha*	ད *da*	ན *na*
པ *pa*	ཕ *pha*	བ *ba*	མ *ma*
ཙ *tsa*	ཚ *tsha*	ཛ *dza*	ཝ *wa*
ཞ *zha*	ཟ *za*	འ *'a*	ཡ *ya*
ར *ra*	ལ *la*	ཤ *sha*	ས *sa*
ཧ *ha*	ཨ *a*		

4 vowel signs – དབྱངས

ི *gi-gu (i)*	ུ *zhab-kyu (u)*	ེ *dreng-bu (e)*	ོ *na-ro (o)*

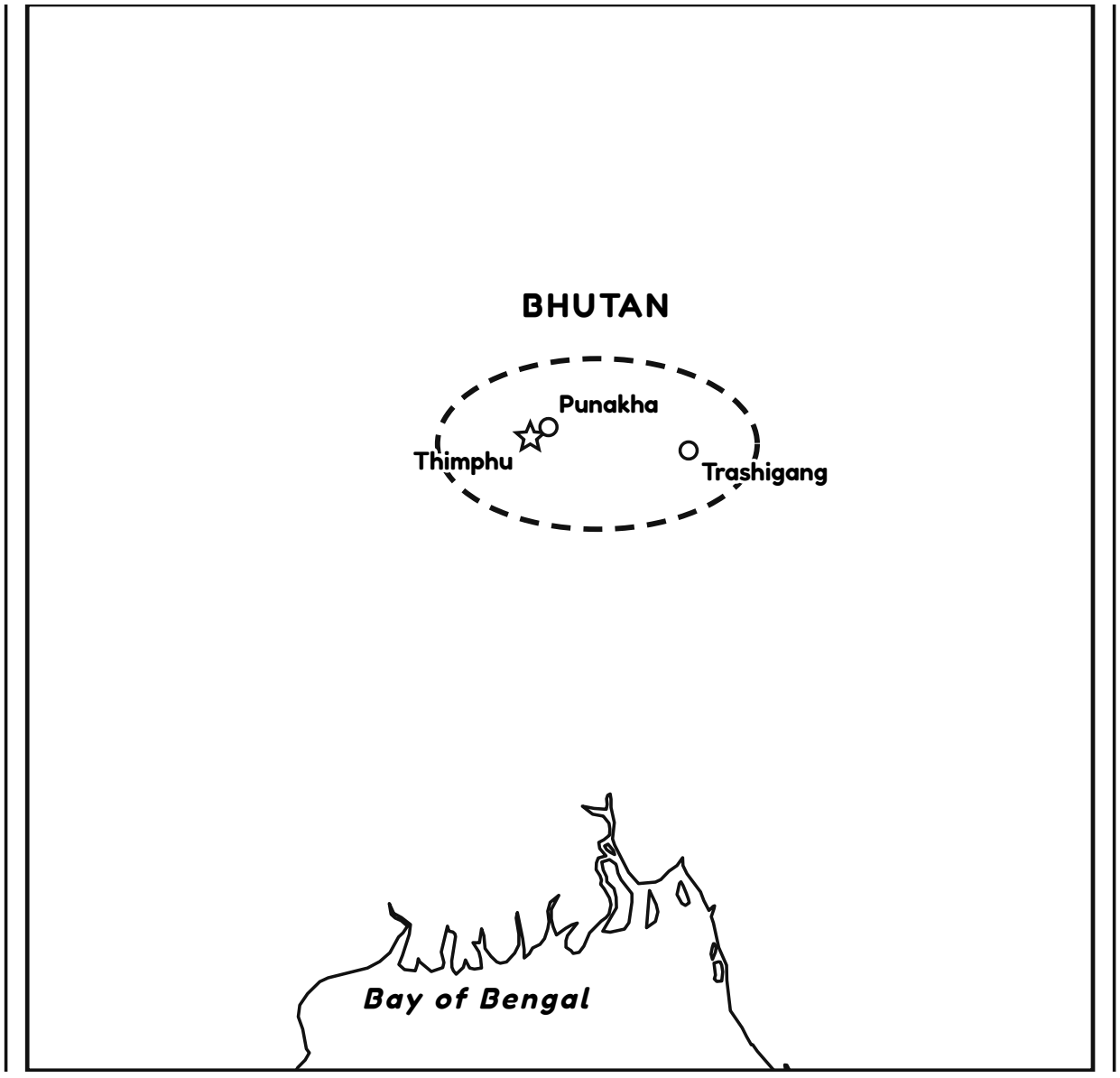
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Bhutan on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Dzongkha spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the sea **blue** · the high mountains **white**. **Find it:** Dzongkha is spoken across Bhutan (inside the dashed line), in towns like Thimphu (the capital), Punakha and Trashigang.

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The Consonants གསལ་བྱེད

sel-je — the 30 letters

Dzongkha has **30 consonants**. Children learn them in rows of four, the same way they are written on the classroom wall in Bhutan: *ka, kha, ga, nga…*

ཀ *ka*	ཁ *kha*	ག *ga*	ང *nga*
ཅ *ca*	ཆ *cha*	ཇ *ja*	ཉ *nya*

Every letter says “a”
A letter on its own already has the vowel **a** in it: ཀ is *ka*, མ is *ma*. To make another vowel, add a vowel sign (you will meet them later in the book).

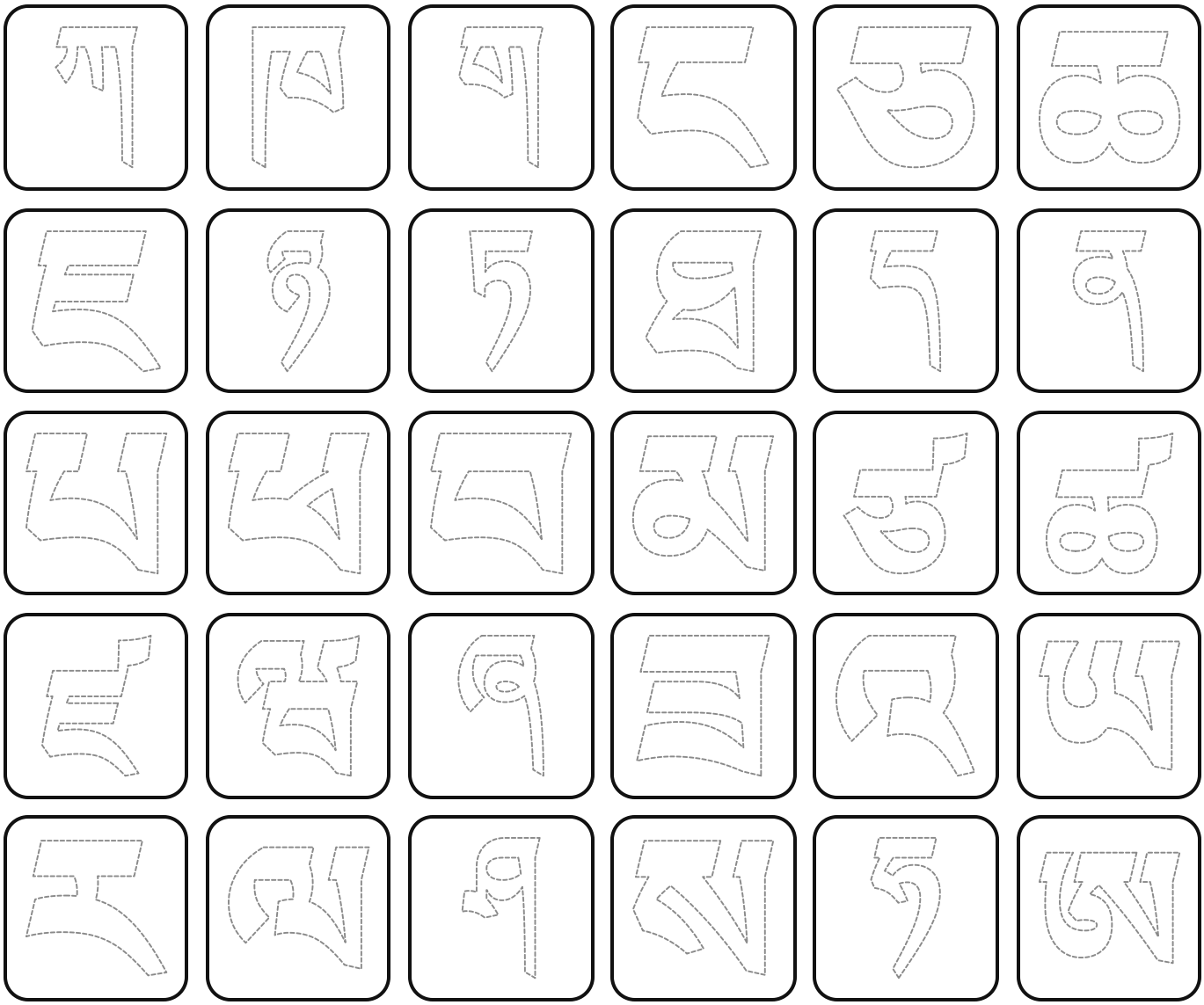
Hanging from a line
Tibetan-script letters hang from an invisible line at the top, and a small dot ་ (*tsheg*) comes after every syllable: ཀུ་ཤུ = ku · shu.

High and low
Some letters are said with a **high** voice and some with a **low** voice. Each letter page tells you which.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the consonants གསལ་བྱེད

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ཀ

NAME · མིང

ཀ

ka

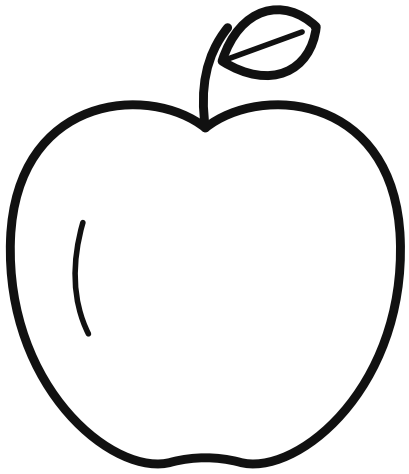
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'k' as in "skip" — no puff of air

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཀ	ཀི	ཀུ	ཀེ	ཀོ
ka	ki	ku	ke	ko

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.



ཀ IS FOR

ཀུ་ཤུ

ku-shu

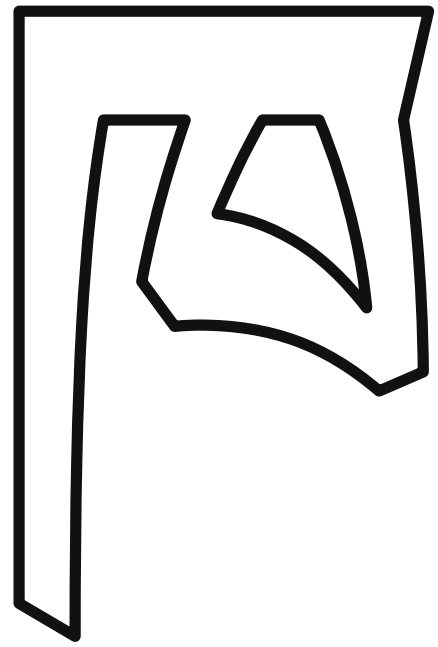
apple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཀ ཀ ཀ ཀ

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NAME · མིང

ཁ

kha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

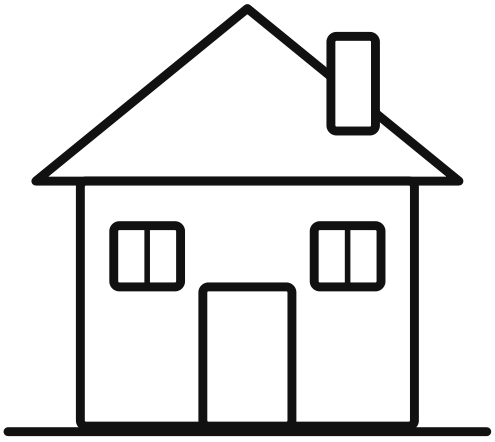
'k' with a puff of air, as in "kite"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཁ	ཁི	ཁུ	ཁེ	ཁོ
kha	khi	khu	khe	kho

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.

Here ཁ has a little ya (ྱ) tucked under it: ཆ says 'chh'.



ཁ IS FOR

ཁྱིམ

chhim

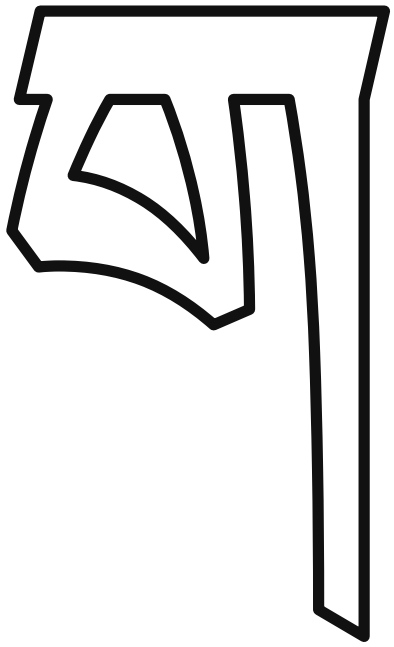
house, home

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཁ ཁ ཁ ཁ

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NAME · མིང

ག

ga

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

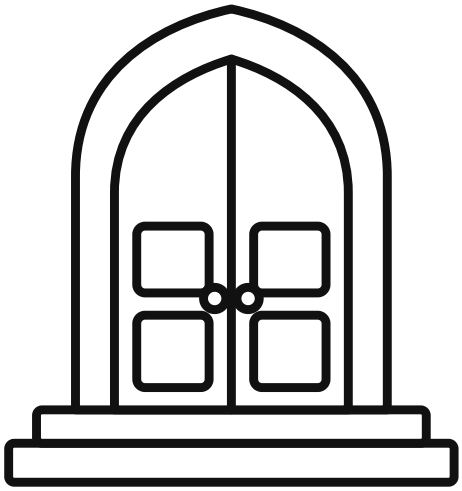
‘g’ as in “go”, said low and soft

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ག	གི	གུ	གེ	གོ
ga	gi	gu	ge	go

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.

The little ས on top is silent: སྒོ says *go*, so ག is the letter you hear.



ག IS FOR

སྒོ

go

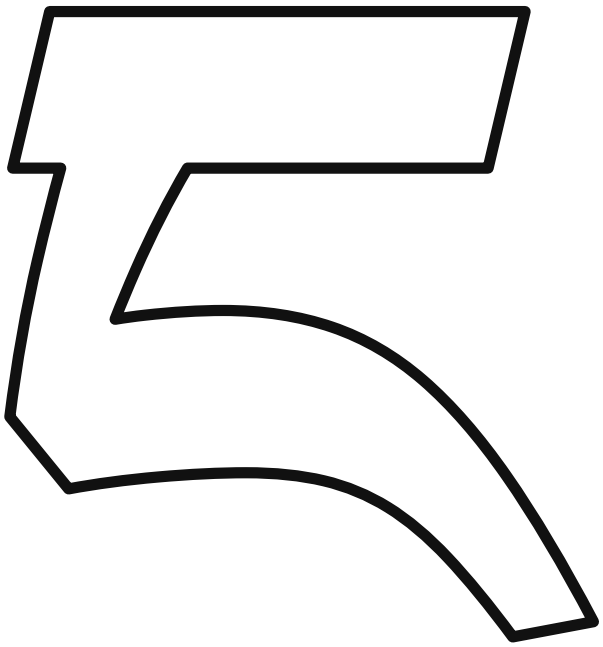
door

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ག ག ག ག

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NAME · མིང

ང

nga

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ng' as in "sing" — but at the start!

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ང	ངི	ངུ	ངེ	ངོ
nga	ngi	ngu	nge	ngo

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.

The little ྃ on top is silent: ང says *nga*, so ྂ is the letter you hear.



ང IS FOR

ང

nga

drum

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ང ང ང ང

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NAME · མིང

ཅ

ca

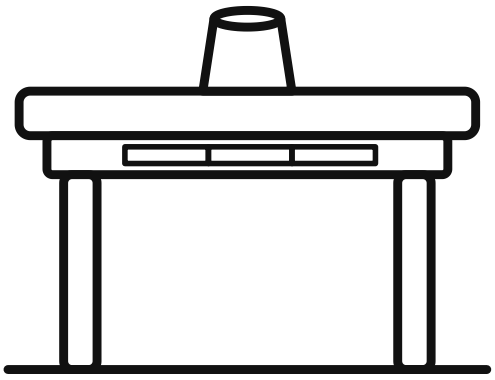
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ch' as in "itchy" — no puff of air

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཅ	ཅི	ཅུ	ཅེ	ཅོ
ca	ci	cu	ce	co

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.



ཅ IS FOR

ཅོག་རྩེ

chog-tse

table

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཅ ཅ ཅ ཅ

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NAME · མིང

ཆ

cha

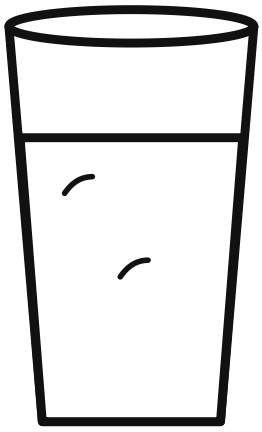
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ with a puff of air, as in “cheese” (written chh)

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཆ	ཆི	ཆུ	ཆེ	ཆོ
cha	chi	chu	che	cho

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.



ཆ IS FOR

ཆུ

chhu

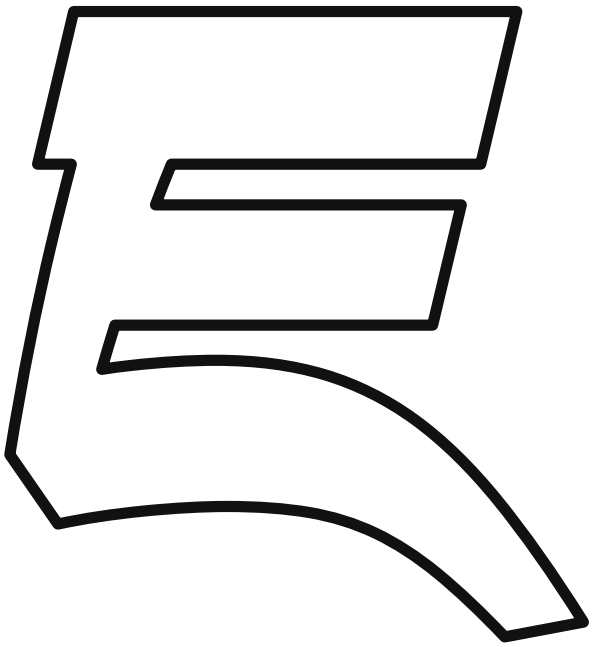
water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཆ ཆ ཆ ཆ

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NAME · མིང

ཇ

ja

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'j' as in "jam", said low

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཇ	ཇི	ཇུ	ཇེ	ཇོ
ja	ji	ju	je	jo

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.

ཇ on its own is a whole word: *ja*, tea!



ཇ IS FOR

ཇ

ja

tea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཇ ཇ ཇ ཇ

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NAME · མིང

ཉ

nya

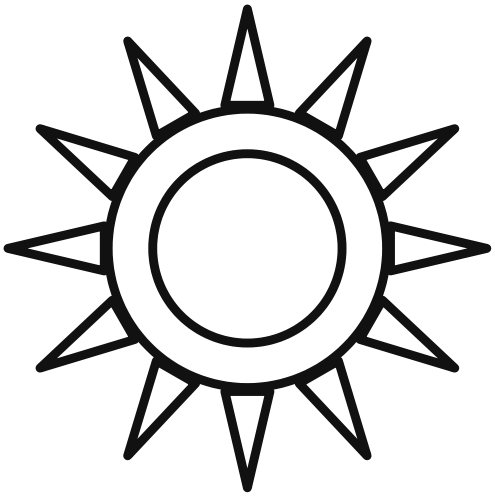
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ny' as in "canyon"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཉ	ཉི	ཉུ	ཉེ	ཉོ
nya	nyi	nyu	nye	nyo

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.



ཉ IS FOR

ཉིམ

nyim

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཉ ཉ ཉ ཉ

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NAME · མིང

ཏ

ta

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “stop” — no puff of air

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཏ	ཏི	ཏུ	ཏེ	ཏོ
ta	ti	tu	te	to

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.



ཏ IS FOR

ཏོ

to

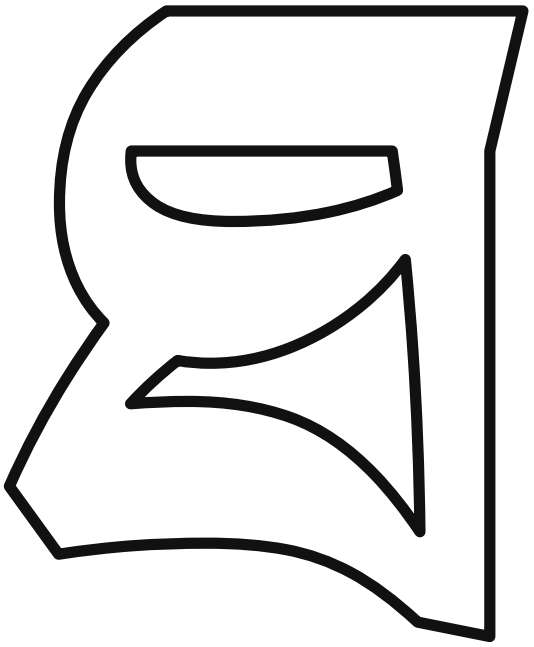
rice, a meal

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཏ ཏ ཏ ཏ

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NAME · མིང

ཐ

tha

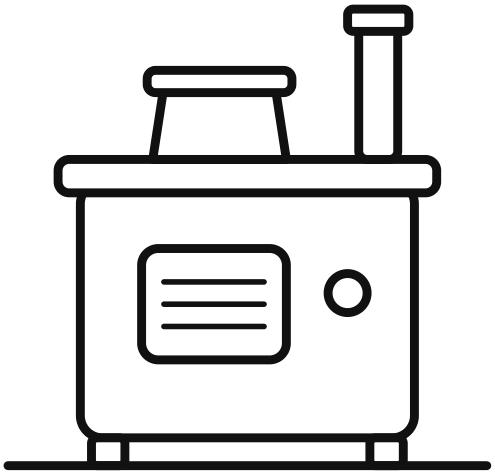
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

't' with a puff of air, as in "top"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཐ	ཐི	ཐུ	ཐེ	ཐོ
tha	thi	thu	the	tho

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.



ཐ IS FOR

ཐབ

thap

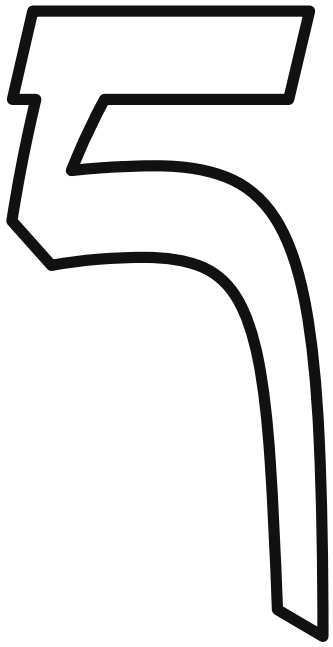
stove, cooking fire

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཐ ཐ ཐ ཐ

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NAME · མིང

ད

da

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

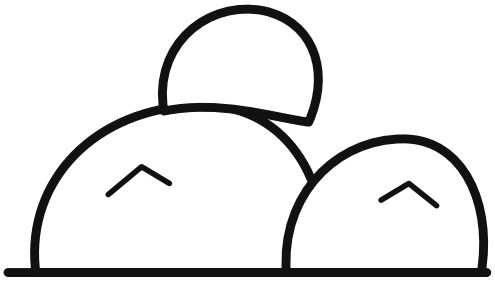
'd' as in "dot", said low

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ད	དི	དུ	དེ	དོ
da	di	du	de	do

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.

The little ྲ on top is silent: དྲོ says *do*, so ད is the letter you hear.



ད IS FOR

དོ

do

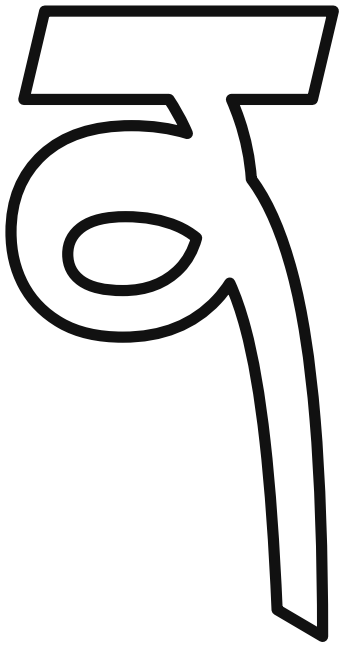
stone

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འཛིལ

ད ད ད ད

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NAME · མིང

ན

na

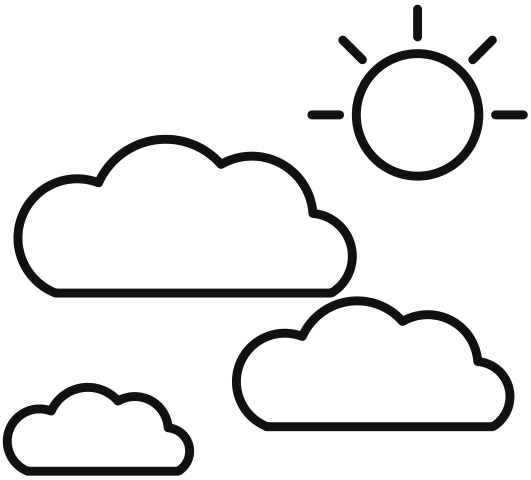
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'n' as in "net"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ན	ནི	ནུ	ནེ	ནོ
na	ni	nu	ne	no

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.



ན IS FOR

ནམ་མཁའ

nam-kha

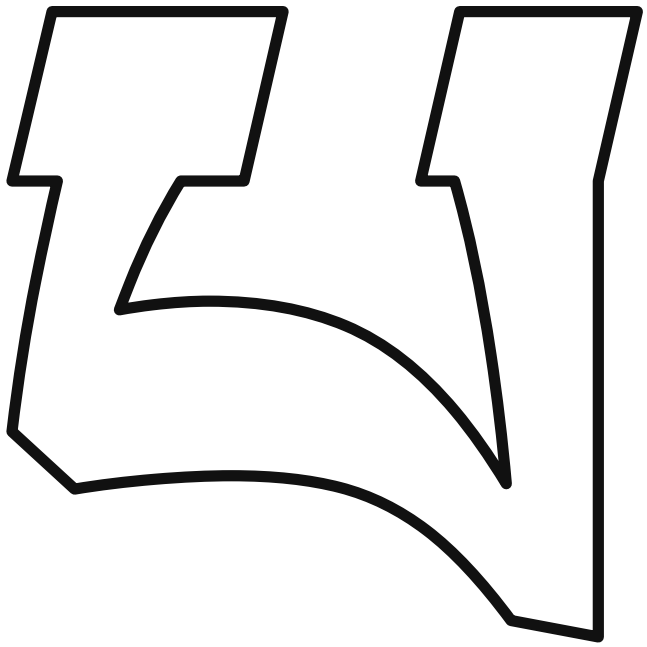
sky

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ན ན ན ན

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NAME · མིང

ཕ

pa

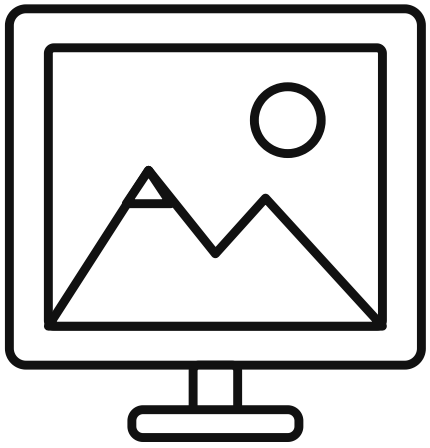
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'p' as in "spin" — no puff of air

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཕ	ཕི	ཕུ	ཕེ	ཕོ
pa	pi	pu	pe	po

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.



ཕ IS FOR

པར

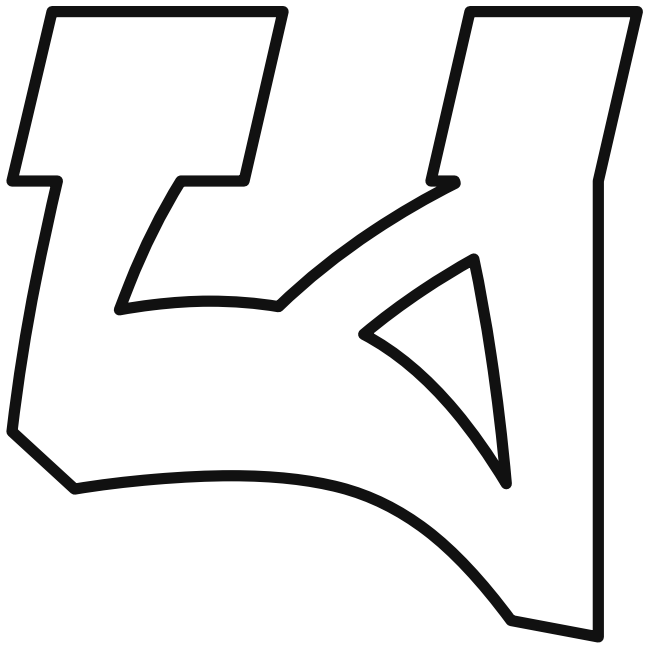
par

picture, photo

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འཐུས

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NAME · མིང

ཕ

pha

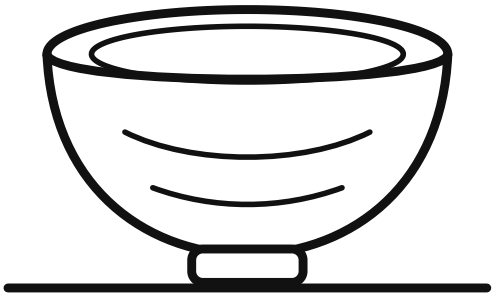
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'p' with a puff of air, as in "pin"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཕ	ཕི	ཕུ	ཕེ	ཕོ
pha	phi	phu	phe	pho

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.



ཕ **IS FOR**

ཕོབ

phob

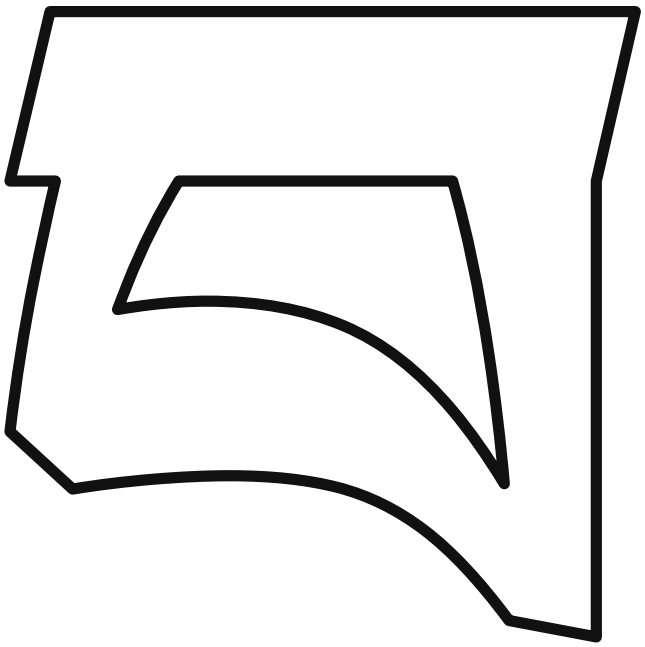
bowl, cup

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཕ ཕ ཕ ཕ

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NAME · མིང

བ

ba

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “bat”, said low

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

བ	བི	བུ	བེ	བོ
ba	bi	bu	be	bo

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.



བ IS FOR

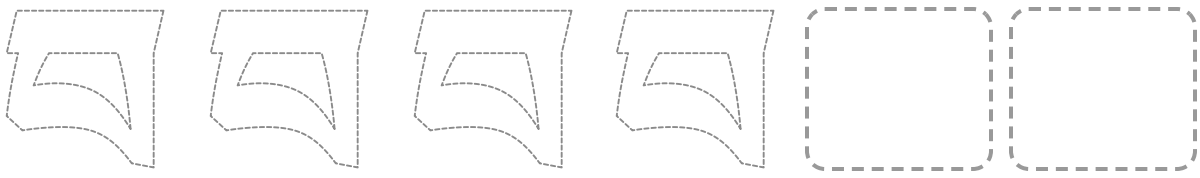
བང་ཆུང

bang-chung

bamboo basket

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི



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NAME · མིང

མ

ma

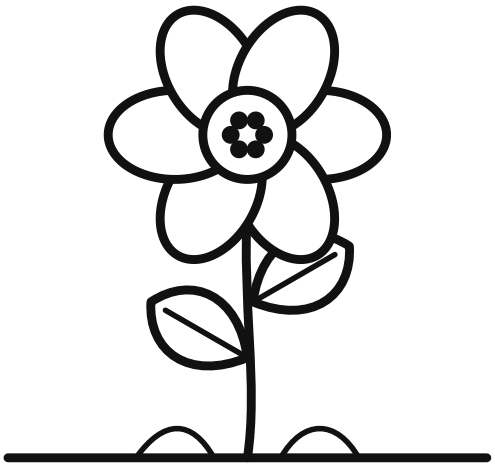
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'm' as in "moon"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

མ	མི	མུ	མེ	མོ
ma	mi	mu	me	mo

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.



མ IS FOR

མེ་ཏོག

me-tog

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

མ མ མ མ

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NAME · མིང

ཙ

tsa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

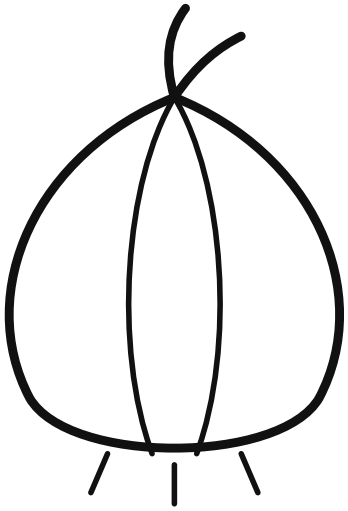
'ts' as in "cats"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཙ	ཙི	ཙུ	ཙེ	ཙོ
tsa	tsi	tsu	tse	tso

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.

The little ག in front is silent: གཙོང་ says *tsong*, so ཙ is the letter you hear.



ཙ IS FOR

གཙོང་

tsong

onion

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཙ ཙ ཙ ཙ

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NAME · མིང

ཚ

tsha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

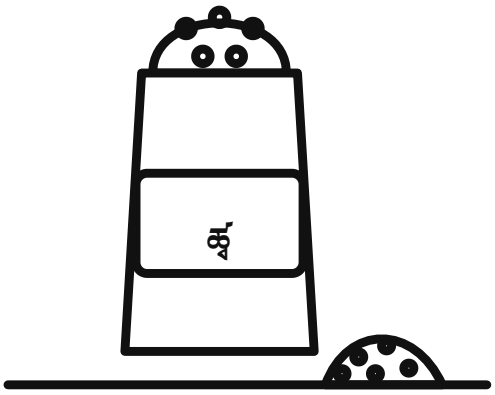
'ts' with a puff of air

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཚ	ཚི	ཚུ	ཚེ	ཚོ
tsha	tshi	tshu	tshe	tsho

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.

The little hook under ཚ (ྀ) does not change the sound: ཚྀ says *tsha*.



ཚ IS FOR

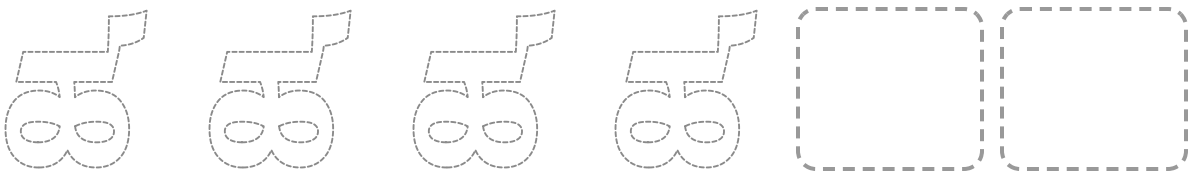
ཚྀ

tsha

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི



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NAME · མིང

ཛ

dza

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

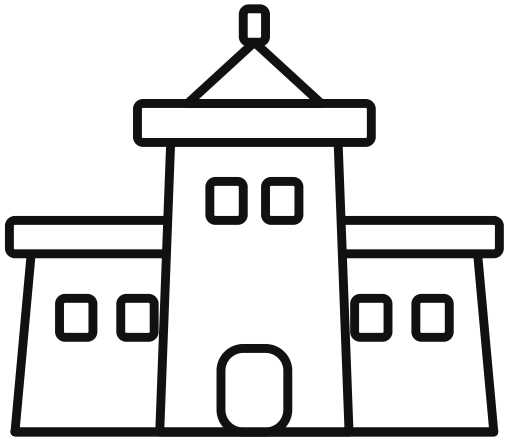
‘dz’ as in “adze”, said low

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཛ	ཛི	ཛུ	ཛེ	ཛོ
dza	dzi	dzu	dze	dzo

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.

ཛ is rare on its own; it usually wears a silent ར hat, as in རྫོང. The word Dzongkha means “the language of the dzong”.



ཛ IS FOR

རྫོང

dzong

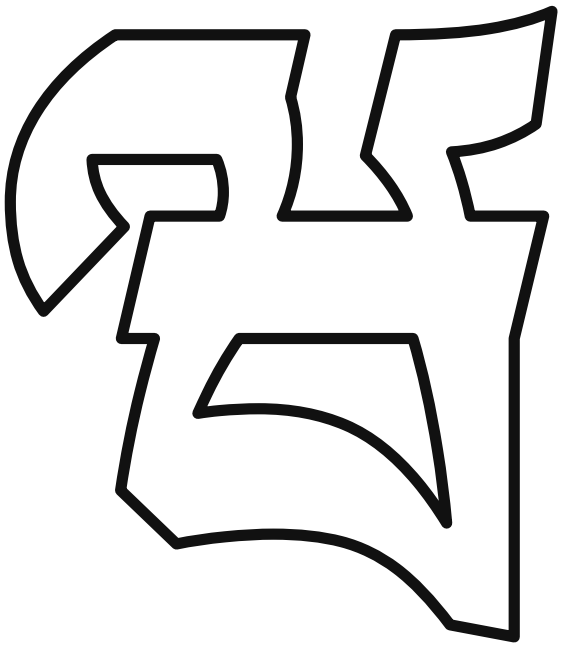
fortress — a big castle building

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཛ ཛ ཛ ཛ

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NAME · མིང

ཕ

wa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'w' as in "wet"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཕ	ཕི	ཕུ	ཕེ	ཕོ
wa	wi	wu	we	wo

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.

Sound-practice page. ཕ is a rare letter, used mostly in borrowed words and names, so there is no picture word here.



ཕ IS FOR

ཕ

wa

sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཕ ཕ ཕ ཕ

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ཞ

NAME · མིང

ཞ

zha

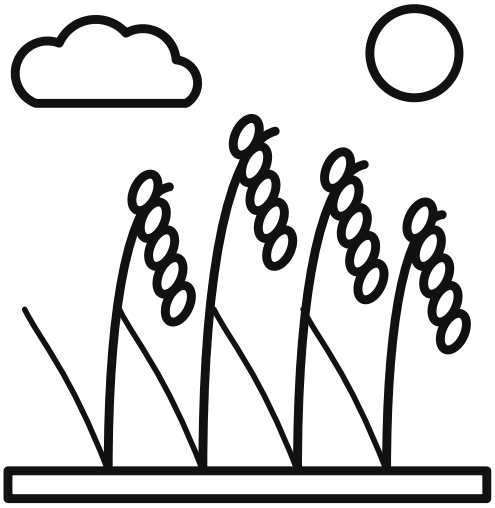
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'zh' like the 's' in "measure"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཞ	ཞི	ཞུ	ཞེ	ཞོ
zha	zhi	zhu	zhe	zho

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.



ཞ **IS FOR**

ཞིང

zhing

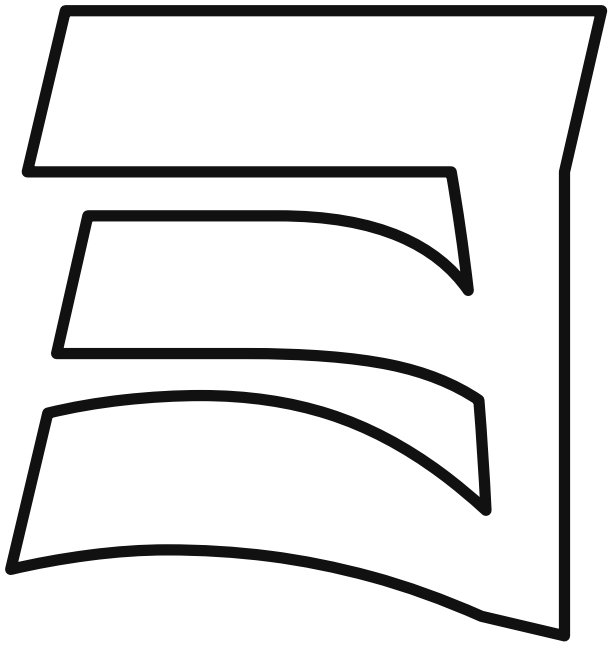
field

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཞ ཞ ཞ ཞ

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NAME · མིང

ཟ

za

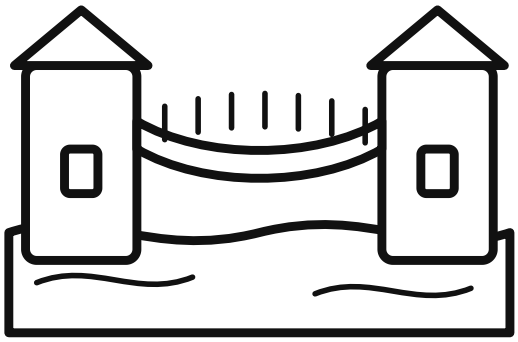
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'z' as in "zoo"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཟ	ཟི	ཟུ	ཟེ	ཟོ
za	zi	zu	ze	zo

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.



ཟ IS FOR

ཟམ

zam

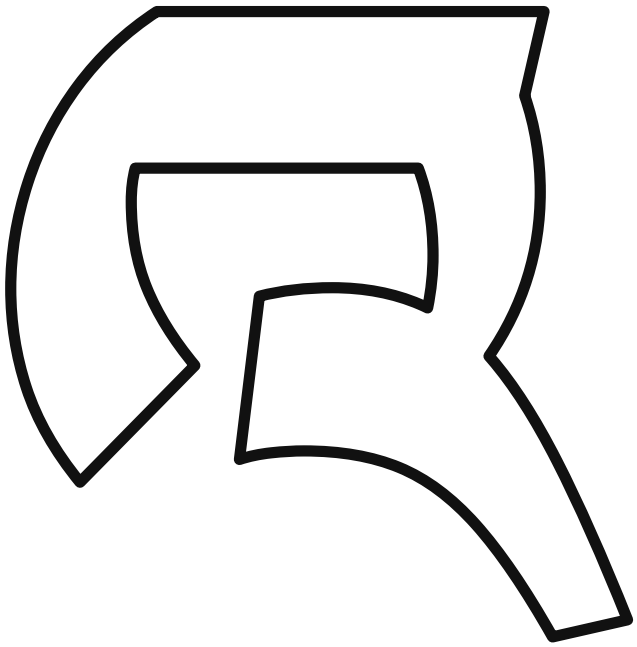
bridge

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཟ ཟ ཟ ཟ

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NAME · མིང

ཨ

'a

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft, low ‘a’ with no consonant sound

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཨ	ཨི	ཨུ	ཨེ	ཨོ
'a	'i	'u	'e	'o

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.



ཨ IS FOR

ཨོམ

om

milk

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཨ ཨ ཨ ཨ

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NAME · མིང

ཡ

ya

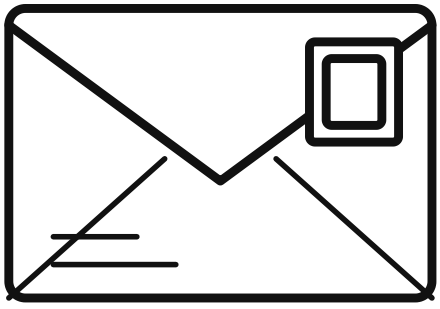
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཡ	ཡི	ཡུ	ཡེ	ཡོ
ya	yi	yu	ye	yo

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.



ཡ IS FOR

ཡི་གུ

yi-gu

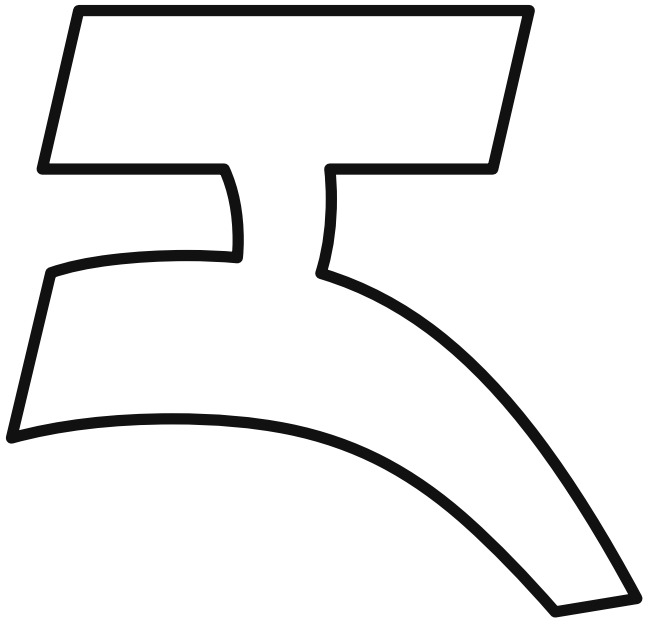
letter (to post)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཡ ཡ ཡ ཡ

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NAME · མིང

ར

ra

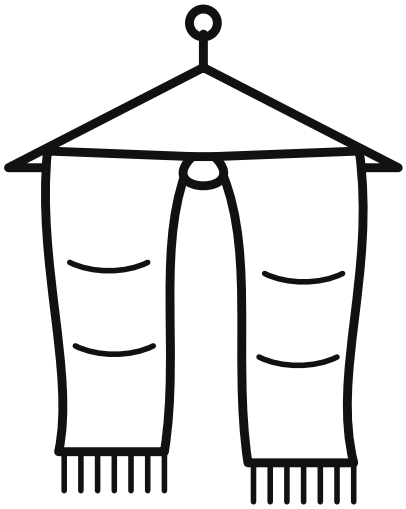
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a light, tapped ‘r’

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ར	རི	རུ	རེ	རོ
ra	ri	ru	re	ro

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.



ར IS FOR

རན

rä

cloth

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ར ར ར ར

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NAME · མིང

ལ

la

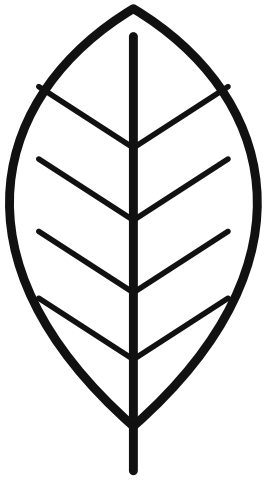
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ལ	ལི	ལུ	ལེ	ལོ
la	li	lu	le	lo

Low tone: say it with a lower, softer voice.



ལ IS FOR

ལོ་མ

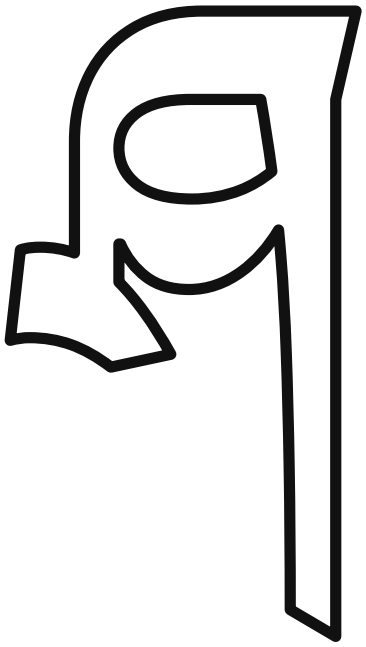
lo-ma

leaf

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འཛིན

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NAME · མིང

ཤ

sha

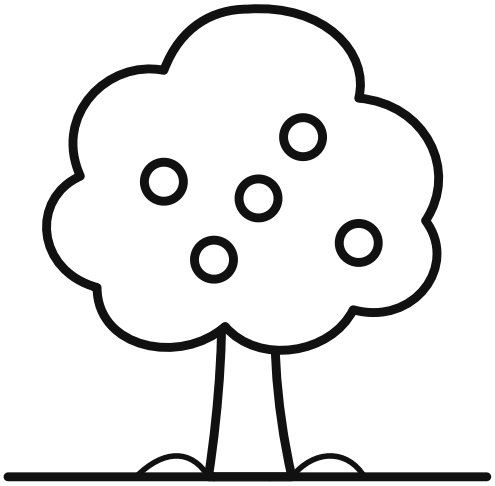
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'sh' as in "shop"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཤ	ཤི	ཤུ	ཤེ	ཤོ
sha	shi	shu	she	sho

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.



ཤ **IS FOR**

ཤིང

shing

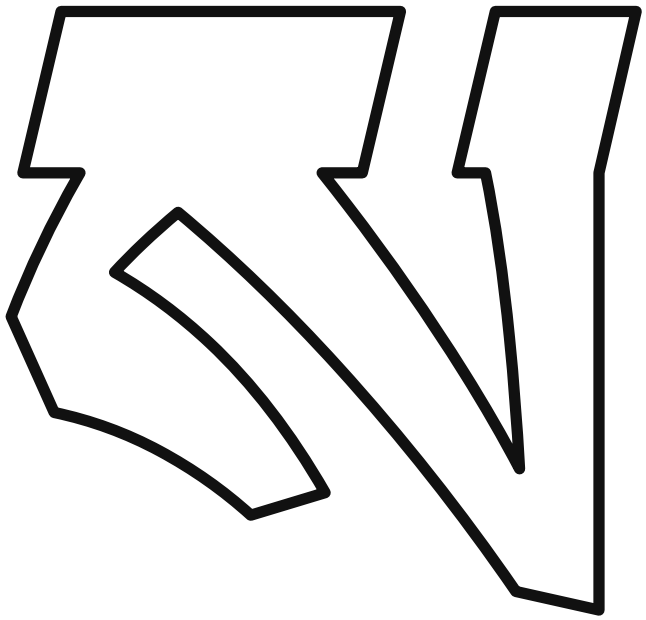
tree, wood

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཤ ཤ ཤ ཤ

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NAME · མིང

ས

sa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

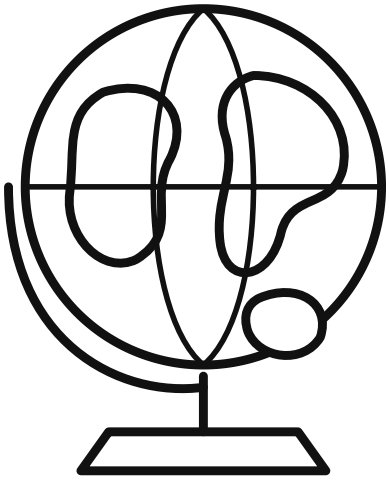
's' as in "sun"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ས	སི	སུ	སེ	སོ
sa	si	su	se	so

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.

ས on its own is a whole word: *sa*, the earth or the ground.



ས IS FOR

ས

sa

earth, land

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ས ས ས ས

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ཧ

NAME · མིང

ཧ

ha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'h' as in "hat"

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཧ	ཧི	ཧུ	ཧེ	ཧོ
ha	hi	hu	he	ho

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.

Few everyday words start with ཧ. Say it with a smile: *ha-chang* means "very"!



ཧ IS FOR

ཧ་ཅང

ha-chang

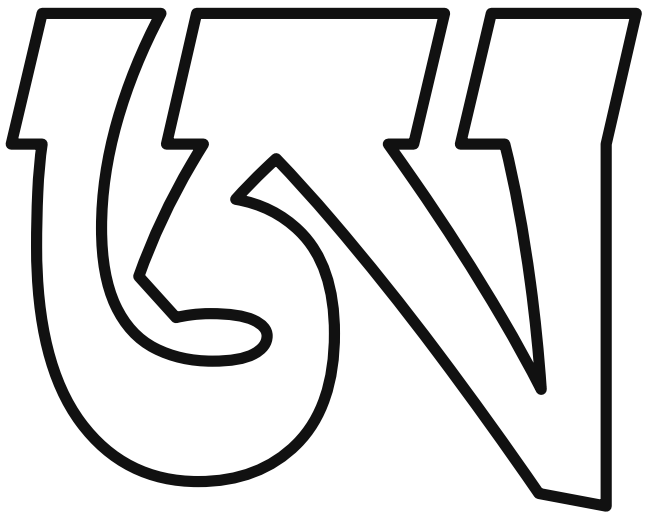
very, very much

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཧ ཧ ཧ ཧ

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NAME · མིང

ཨ

a

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

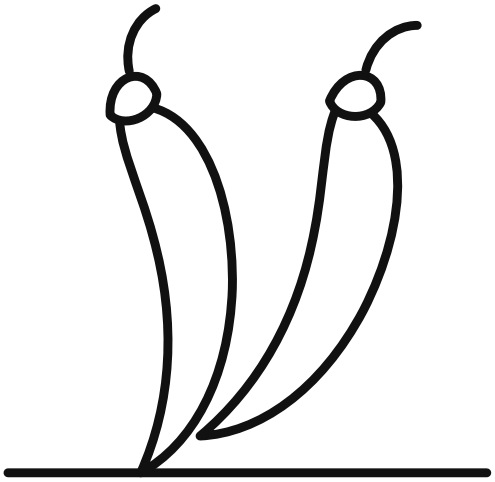
a plain ‘a’ as in “father”, said high

WITH THE 4 VOWELS · TONE

ཨ	ཨི	ཨུ	ཨེ	ཨོ
a	i	u	e	o

High tone: say it with a higher, clear voice.

Bhutan’s favourite dish is *ema datshi*: chillies cooked with cheese!



ཨ IS FOR

ཨེ་མ

e-ma

chilli

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འཕྲི

ཨ ཨ ཨ ཨ

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The Vowel Signs དབྱངས

yang — the 4 vowel signs

Dzongkha has **four vowel signs**. They are not letters on their own: they sit **on top of** or **under** a letter and change its “a” into *i, u, e* or *o*.

ཀི	ཀུ	ཀེ	ཀོ
ki	*ku*	*ke*	*ko*

The vowel carrier ཨ

To write a vowel all alone, put the sign on ཨ (a): ཨི ཨུ ཨེ ཨོ = i, u, e, o.

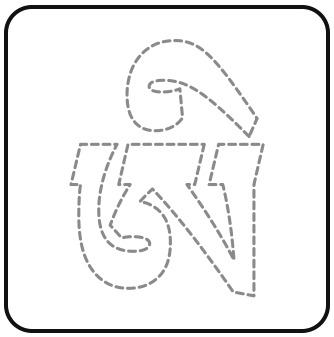
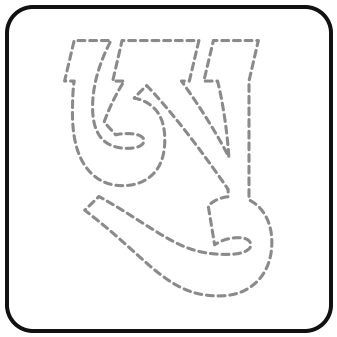
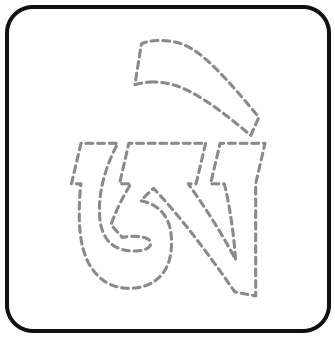
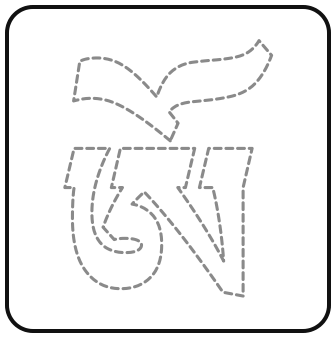
Three on top, one below

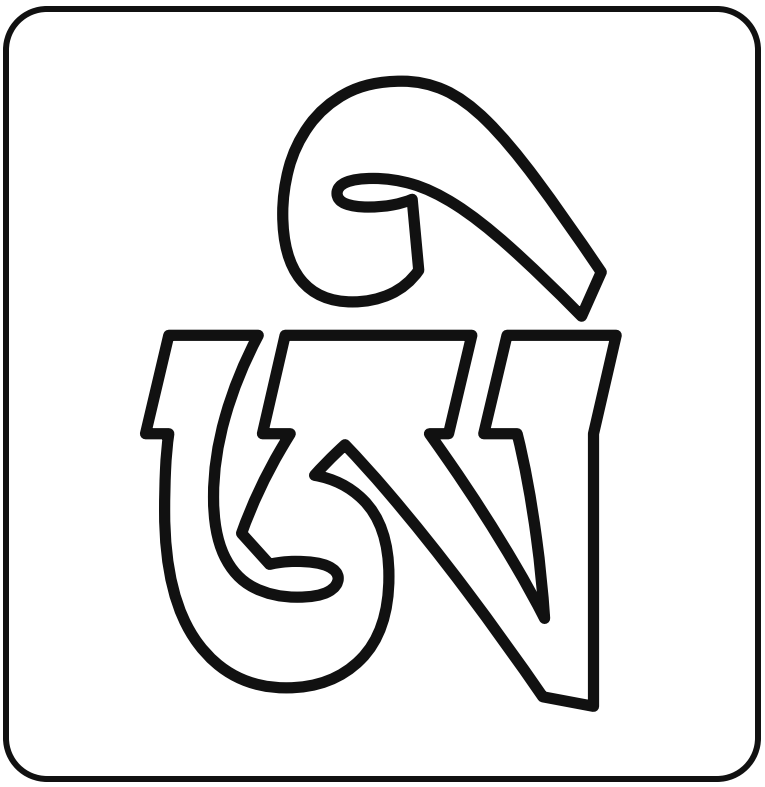
gigu, *drengbu* and *naro* sit on top; *zhabkyu* hangs underneath.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the vowel signs དབྱངས

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



NAME · མིང

གི་གུ

gi-gu (i)

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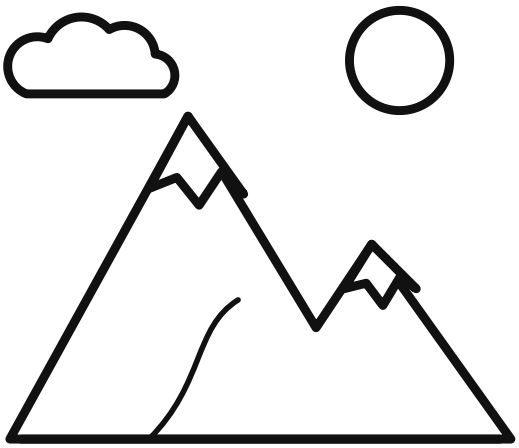
'ee' as in "see"

ON OTHER LETTERS

ཀི	ཁི	གི	ངི	ཅི
ki	khi	gi	ngi	ci

gigu sits **on top** of the letter, like a little hook.

Here the sign sits on ཨ, the letter that carries a vowel alone.



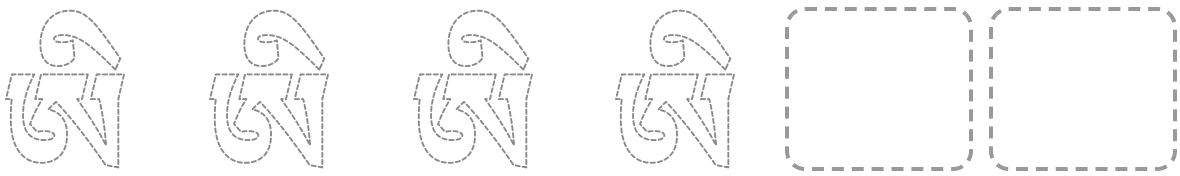
ཨི IS FOR ཧྲི

ri

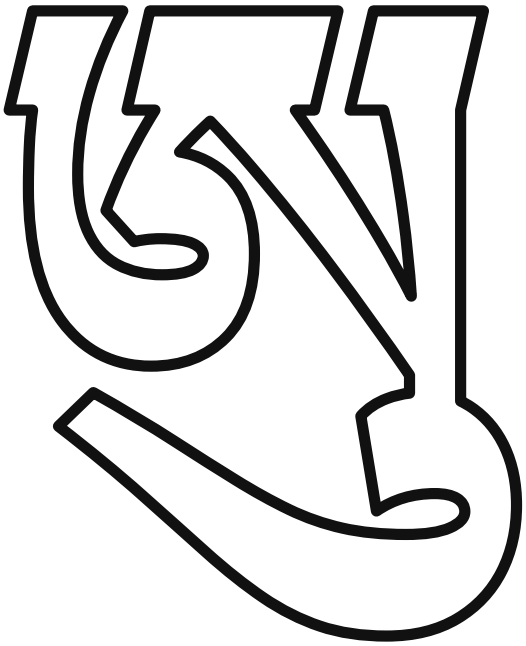
hill, mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི



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NAME · མིང

ཞབས་ཀྱུ

zhab-kyu (u)

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

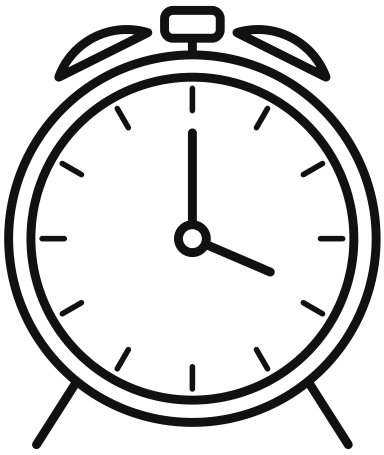
'oo' as in "moon"

ON OTHER LETTERS

ཀུ	ཁུ	གུ	ངུ	ཅུ
ku	khu	gu	ngu	cu

zhabkyu hangs **under** the letter, like a little foot.

Here the sign sits on ཨ, the letter that carries a vowel alone.



ཨུ IS FOR

ཆུ་ཚོད

chhu-tshö

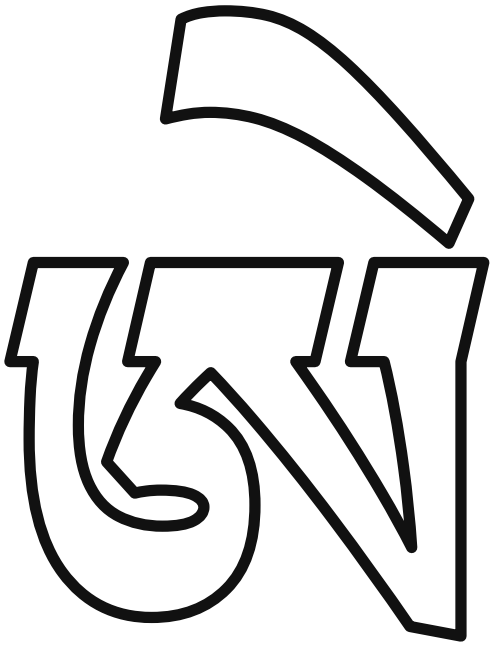
clock

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

ཨུ ཨུ ཨུ ཨུ

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NAME · མིང

འབྲེང་བུ

dreng-bu (e)

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'e' as in "bed"

ON OTHER LETTERS

ཀེ	ཁེ	གེ	ངེ	ཅེ
ke	khe	ge	nge	ce

drengbu sits **on top**, leaning like a little flag.

Here the sign sits on ཨ, the letter that carries a vowel alone.



ཨེ IS FOR

མེ

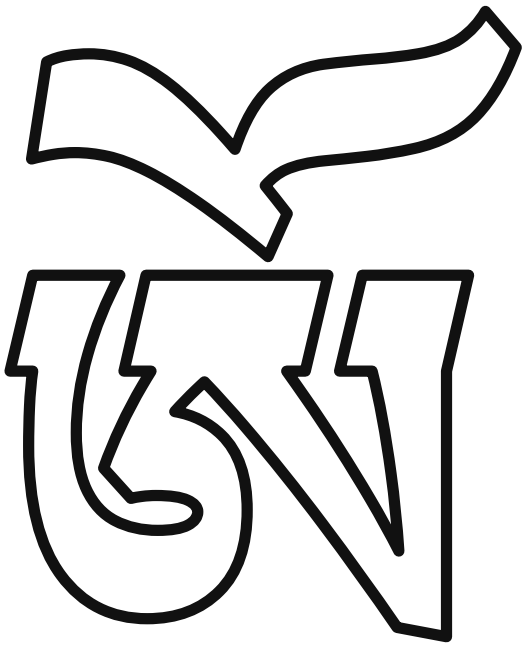
me

fire

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

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NAME · མིང

ན་རོ་

na-ro (o)

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

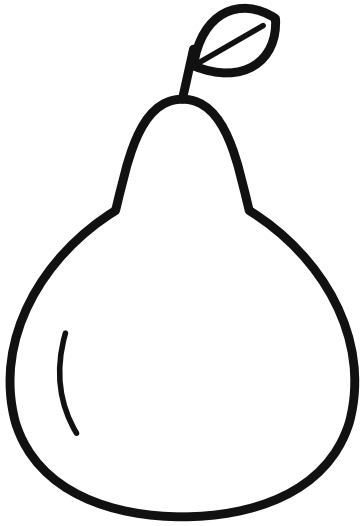
‘o’ as in “go”

ON OTHER LETTERS

ཀོ	ཁོ	གོ	ངོ	ཅོ
ko	kho	go	ngo	co

naro sits **on top**, curling both ways.

Here the sign sits on ཨ, the letter that carries a vowel alone.



ཨོ IS FOR

ཤིང་ཏོག

shing-tog

fruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · འབྲི

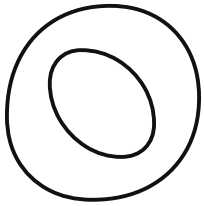
ཨོ ཨོ ཨོ ཨོ

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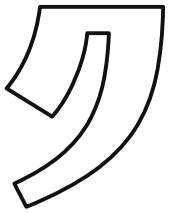
BONUS

Dzongkha numbers ཨང་གྲངས *(ang-drang)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Dzongkha: *lä-kor, chi, nyi, sum...*



0
ལྷ་ཀོར
lä-kor
zero



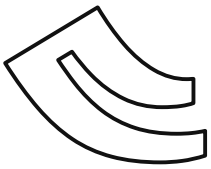
1
གཅིག
chi
one



2
གཉིས
nyi
two



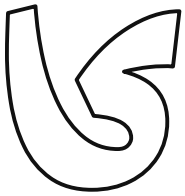
3
གསུམ
sum
three



4
བཞི
zhi
four



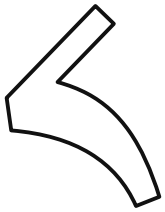
5
ལྔ
nga
five



6
དྲུག
druk
six



7
བདུན
dün
seven



8
བརྒྱད
gä
eight



9
དགུ
gu
nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Dzongkha words ཀུ་ཟུ་ཟངཔོ་ལ།

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

ཨསསལྷུམུཨལཻཀུམ།
as-sa-LAA-mu a-LAI-kum
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

ཝཨལཻཀུམཨསསལྷམ།
wa a-LAI-kum as-sa-LAAM
And upon you be peace (the reply)

ཀུ་ཟུ་ཟངཔོ་ལ།
ku-zu zang-po la
Hello!

ངའི་མིང་ ... ཨིན།
ngä ming ... in
My name is ...

བཀའ་དྲིན་ཆེ་ལ།
ka-drin chhe la
Thank you

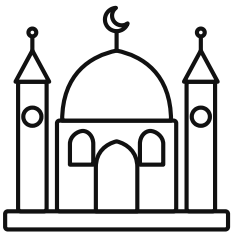
ཇ་ཟཱཀལ་ལྷ་ཧུ་ཁཻ་རྣན།
ja-ZAA-kal-laa-hu KHAI-raan
Jazakallahu khairan — May Allah reward you with good

ཨ་མ · ཨ་པ
a-ma · a-pa
Mother · Father

ཨ་ཏ · ཨ་ཞེམ
a-ta · a-zhem
Big brother · Big sister

ཨིན། · མེན།
in · men
Yes (it is) · No (it is not)

ང་རྫོང་ཁ་ལྷབ་དོ།
nga dzong-kha lhab do
I am learning Dzongkha!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

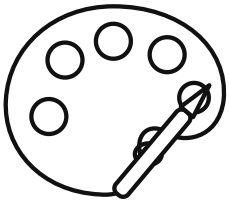
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International); the Dzongkha alphabet as taught by the **Dzongkha Development Commission** of Bhutan.

What's next?
You have met all **34 Dzongkha letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Dzongkha, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

མ་བྷ་ཛལ་ལྷ། ལེགས་ཤོམ་ཨིན།

MAA-shaa-al-laa! leg-shom in! — Mashallah! Well done — that is good!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 34 letters of the Dzongkha alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

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